

WILLIAM ELIAS

Senior DevOps / Platform Engineer | CI/CD Automation | Production Reliability | AI-Enabled Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior DevOps and platform engineer with 10+ years spanning infrastructure and networking, software QA, automation, production operations, and delivery engineering. Built 100+ Azure DevOps CI/CD pipelines and reusable release automation for .NET applications using YAML, Python, PowerShell, IIS, artifacts, environment controls, and approval gates. Hands-on with Azure Monitor, Application Insights, KQL, Key Vault, OAuth/IAM, SQL Server, GitHub Actions, Docker/Helm, and production incident and release workflows. Built automation that reduced processing time by 60% and saved 40+ hours per month, while adding practical AI-assisted engineering systems for grounded knowledge, troubleshooting, and agent workflows.

CORE EXPERTISE

DevOps & Delivery: Azure DevOps, CI/CD, YAML, reusable pipelines, Classic Release, GitHub Actions, Git, Bitbucket, artifact management, release gates, IIS

Automation & Software: Python, PowerShell, C#, Go, Bash, SQL, REST APIs, .NET Framework/.NET 8, ASP.NET Core, FastAPI, XML/ETL

Observability & Reliability: Azure Monitor, Application Insights, KQL, Serilog, structured logging, incident triage, RCA, SLA support, release coordination

Cloud, Security & Identity: Azure Key Vault, Managed Identity, OAuth 2.0, IAM, secrets discovery/remediation, credential/PII scanning, rollback validation

Platform & Infrastructure: Windows Server, IIS, Active Directory, SQL Server, Docker, Helm, Kubernetes deployment packaging, load balancers, firewalls, Cisco, Meraki

AI Engineering: RAG, ChromaDB, MCP, LLM API integration, multi-agent workflows, context engineering, prompt-injection defenses, AI guardrails

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Stellantis Financial Services | Feb 2023 - Present

Production Support Engineer - DevOps & Automation | Auburn Hills, MI

- Built and delivered 100+ Azure DevOps CI/CD pipelines and reusable YAML/release automation for .NET applications, using Python and PowerShell for artifact generation, IIS deployment, environment controls, approvals, and repeatable onboarding.
- Designed deployment-safety controls for a large application estate, including repository-to-server/path inventory, dry-run validation, and environment-readiness checks; guardrails caught a mapping defect that could have deployed one application into six incorrect production folders.
- Lead weekly production releases, database migrations, and SLA-driven incident/service-request work through Freshservice and Jira; troubleshoot Azure Monitor, Application Insights, KQL, OAuth/IAM, database, API, configuration, and network-connectivity issues.
- Remediated exposed credentials across 100+ repositories and built secure Key Vault migration/rollback tooling with discovery, classification, integrity validation, and credential/PII safeguards.
- Co-led production/test server migration and DR work across Windows Server, IIS, Active Directory, firewall, database, application, and load-balancer layers, including a zero-downtime cutover from legacy infrastructure.
- Built internal AI-enabled knowledge and incident-triage tooling that synchronizes Jira, Confluence, and SharePoint context while enforcing credential, PII, provenance, and engineer-review controls.

HBK Engineering Solutions | Jul 2020 - Feb 2023

DevOps Engineer - Python Automation | Southfield, MI

- Created a Python/Tkinter XML-output automation system that reduced data-processing time by 60%.
- Automated SQL output processing with Python, saving more than 40 hours per month.
- Developed database-configuration tools that streamlined customer onboarding and reduced repetitive setup across application environments.
- Built NSIS installer/uninstaller packages, maintained Git workflows and developer tooling, and provided live technical troubleshooting for customers.

Intrepid Control Systems | Mar 2020 - Apr 2020

QA Developer

- Wrote and executed Mocha test cases for internal software applications and debugged/validated APIs across software and hardware integrations.

Project Worldwide | Jan 2020 - Mar 2020

Network Engineer

- Configured Cisco and Meraki infrastructure across enterprise locations and executed multi-state network migrations with minimal operational downtime.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

Ford Motor Company | Sep 2019 - Dec 2019

Network Standards Engineer

- Implemented global network standards and created scalable documentation and IP-management systems for enterprise infrastructure.

Trendset Communications Group | Sep 2015 - Jun 2019

IT Network Engineer

- Enforced network standards, maintained configuration files and documentation, and supported critical production infrastructure.

SELECTED DEVOPS & PLATFORM ENGINEERING HIGHLIGHTS

CI/CD & Release Engineering

- Designed the standard .NET build/release pattern for approximately 60 internal web applications across five servers that previously had no consistent deployment path.
- Built a repository-to-server-to-deployment-path inventory, a generator that emits build pipelines, and multi-tier Azure DevOps Classic Release definitions; 28 of 60 applications are wired and build-verified, with 27 currently green.
- Deployment-path dry-run validation caught a generator mapping defect that would have mirrored the wrong application into six production folders; also built reusable Python/.NET pipeline templates and a WSL2 + Rancher Desktop container-host proof of concept behind IIS ARR.

Tech: Azure DevOps YAML, Classic Release, Deployment Groups, Azure DevOps REST, PowerShell, Python, IIS, MSBuild, .NET Framework/.NET 8, WSL2, Rancher Desktop, IIS ARR

Credential Hygiene & Secrets Remediation

- Built audit and Git-history remediation tooling that removed exposed credentials from 100+ repositories, including historical branches.
- Built a purpose-built .NET 8 utility for hash-only secret discovery, classification, Azure Key Vault migration, and integrity-verified rollback, backed by 62 automated tests; a measured server run scanned 2,832 files and identified 67 distinct secrets in 25 seconds.
- Self-review caught and corrected a migration-path integrity flaw before rollout, providing direct evidence of testing discipline and rollback safety.

Tech: .NET 8, C#, Spectre.Console, xUnit, Azure Key Vault, Managed Identity, Python, PowerShell, Git History Rewriting

Internal Web Apps & Support Platform

- Expanded a single-purpose query extractor into a modular ASP.NET Core support portal with a module framework, per-module access policies, and a permanently retained SOX audit trail.
- Added DBA approve-only deployment scripts, live-object diffing, a pre-CAB dashboard, and request tracking that feeds the existing service desk; covered by 156 automated tests.

Observability & Telemetry

- Contributed to the Application Insights proof of concept that became the team standard, drove adoption across the legacy application estate, added structured logging where none existed, authored the team's reusable KQL library, and used usage telemetry to build an evidence-based application sunset list.

Python Operations Automation & Estate Reduction

- Built PII-masked production-to-lower database copy tooling, failed-payload triage, event-driven query-to-email workflows, XML log parsing, and vendor report conversion.
- Installed and supported Python applications on IIS, built multi-string source search for decommission planning, scripted retirement of 300+ unused legacy applications, and standardized the team on uv.

Server Migration & DR Cutover

- Co-led build-out of four new production/test servers across OS configuration, IIS, Active Directory, firewall, application migration, database, and load-balancer layers, then helped coordinate a zero-downtime cutover from legacy infrastructure.

SELECTED OPEN-SOURCE ENGINEERING

Multi-Agent Engineering Library

github.com/howlcipher/ai_knowledge_library

- Built a shared engineering knowledge, rules, and workflow system for Claude Code, Codex, and Gemini CLI with RAG/ChromaDB retrieval, MCP integrations, Docker/Helm packaging, cross-platform installation, and GitHub Actions quality gates using CodeQL and Bandit SAST.

AI Router

github.com/howlcipher/ai_router

- Built a local coding-agent orchestrator that routes work across Claude Code, Codex CLI, and Gemini/Antigravity using task classification, provider health checks, fallback/circuit-breaker logic, SQLite run history, and captured Git diffs.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATION

M.S. Cyber Defense (In Progress) - Dakota State University

B.S. Information Technology - Colorado State University Global Campus

B.B.A. Business Administration - Rochester College

Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA) - Previously Held - Cisco Networking Academy | 2014 - 2017